

County Administration Workshop: June 23, 2026

1:30 p.m. – Board of Commissioners Conference Room

Attending: Commissioners Ron A. Smith; Colene M. Martin; Gary L. Richardson; and Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Chair Ron Smith called the meeting to order at 1:30 p.m.

1. Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest

The board declared there are no potential conflicts of interest.

2. Department Business

a. Sheriff

1. Adult Jail and Juvenile Detention Levy

Dave Daniel, Sheriff, and Scott Hyde, Community Corrections appeared before the Board to discuss renewal of the existing Adult Jail and Juvenile Detention Levy. Sheriff Daniel explained that the current levy rate of \$0.93 per \$1,000 of assessed value has remained unchanged for ten years. While the levy has historically funded both jail and juvenile detention operations, increasing operational costs have created a structural funding deficit that can no longer be sustained solely through levy revenues.

Sheriff Daniel and Director Hyde proposed renewing the levy at its current rate while utilizing temporary General Fund support for juvenile detention operations. Director Hyde explained that approximately \$0.89 of the levy would be required to maintain current jail operations, leaving approximately \$0.04 available for juvenile detention. Additional funding would be needed to sustain juvenile services until a long-term funding solution could be developed. Discussion included the possibility of establishing a future juvenile services district, timelines required to create and fund a district, voter sentiment regarding taxation, and the importance of maintaining public safety services throughout the County.

Commissioners discussed the financial realities facing the County, the impact of inflation on operating expenses, staffing stability, and the challenges associated with sustaining essential public safety services. Sheriff Daniel emphasized that the proposal would not increase taxes but would instead renew the existing levy rate currently paid by taxpayers. Director Hyde noted that closure of juvenile detention services could result in significant operational and staffing challenges that would take considerable time and resources to rebuild. The Board agreed to continue discussions with legal counsel and staff prior to the July deadline for ballot measures.

b. Recreation

1. Grant Agreement, HB5204 Horse Racing \$1,000,000.00

Tamra Martin, Recreation Director, presented a grant agreement associated with House Bill 5204, which appropriated \$1,000,000 to counties that host horse racing activities. Director Martin explained that Josephine County's circumstances differ from other counties because horse racing operations are conducted through the Southern Oregon Horse Racing Association rather than directly by the County. As a result, the County will largely function as a pass-through entity for grant administration, while the Oregon Racing Commission retains oversight authority for project approvals and expenditures.

Director Martin stated that approved projects include improvements to facilities utilized primarily for horse racing activities, including restroom upgrades beneath the grandstands and drainage improvements associated with horse racing operations. She explained that continued horse racing activities benefit the Fairgrounds through lease revenue, increased public attendance, and additional exposure to Fairgrounds events and facilities. *Commissioner Martin moved to approve Grant Agreement, HB5204 Horse Racing \$1,000,000.00. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call; Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0.*

3. BOARD BUSINESS

a. Union Negotiations Authorization and Criteria

Michelle Shaw, Human Resources, Natalie Eckhardt-Doupe, Human Resources Analyst and Rob Brandes, Public Works met with the Board regarding upcoming labor negotiations and expiration of the current collective bargaining agreement on June 30, 2026. Director Shaw explained that a bargaining unit representative had requested a one-year contract extension and that negotiations must begin immediately to meet upcoming deadlines.

Staff discussed historical negotiation practices, anticipated bargaining topics, including cost-of-living adjustments and healthcare contributions, and the need to establish negotiating authority and parameters. Commissioners reviewed potential negotiation objectives, discussed the importance of maintaining good-faith bargaining practices, and considered the benefits of utilizing internal staff resources rather than outside legal counsel. Staff reported they would continue gathering historical bargaining information and return with additional recommendations as negotiations progress. The Board expressed support for staff continuing negotiations and gathering additional information before final terms are presented for Board consideration.

b. Silverbrook Phase 2 Plat Map Subdivision

The Board reviewed the Silverbrook Phase 2 Plat Map Subdivision. Discussion noted that the subdivision had already received City approval and would add additional residential housing units within the Fruitdale area. Commissioners acknowledged the importance of increasing housing opportunities and reviewed the plat documentation provided for approval.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve Silverbrook Phase 2 Plat Map Subdivision. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call; Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0.

c. Proposed Removal of Murphy Dam on the Applegate River

Chair Smith discussed the proposed removal of Murphy Dam on the Applegate River and recent information received regarding permits obtained through the County Planning Department. Commissioners reviewed concerns regarding the potential loss of irrigation infrastructure, groundwater recharge benefits, agricultural impacts, firefighting water availability, and increased operational costs for local landowners. Discussion also included Water Watch of Oregon's involvement, the regulatory review process, and opportunities for public comment before the Department of Environmental Quality.

Commissioner Martin expressed support for a draft of opposition letter prepared for distribution to regulatory agencies and interested parties. Commissioner Richardson indicated he would like additional time to review the matter but supported continuing discussion. Commissioners agreed that County concerns should be formally communicated and that the letter should be distributed to all relevant agencies and stakeholders. The Board approved moving forward with distribution of the letter without objection.

d. Anne G. Basker Auditorium Rental Application – Josephine County Court- Staff 7/14/26

The Board reviewed an auditorium rental application submitted on behalf of the Josephine County Circuit Court for use of the Anne G. Basker Auditorium. The application was approved without objection.

4. OTHER

5. ADDITIONAL SUBJECT MATTERS FROM COMMISSIONERS/ANNOUNCEMENTS:

Commissioners reminded the public to exercise caution during the current dry weather conditions and encouraged fire safety awareness throughout the community.

The meeting adjourned at 2:28 p.m.